

Event Report: The Future of Work and Skills in the Age of AI

With my busy work and school schedule I was unable to attend any in person events, instead I attended multiple virtual TED talk presentations focused on the evolving relationship between technology, artificial intelligence (AI), and the future of work. The three sessions I joined were Why Digital Skills Matter in the Future of Work by Indra Kusuma, With AI, Anyone Can Be a Coder Now by Thomas Dohmke, and The Future of Skills in the Age of AI by David Timis. These three choices were chosen by AI to help shorten the time searching through Ted talks, finding some that interest me and have to do with my career field. All three videos explore how digital transformations are reshaping career paths, skill requirements, and opportunities in technology-driven fields. In this report I'll summarize each video, analyzing their relevance to the field of Information Science, and reflecting on how the ideas presented connect to my own career goals in web development and information science.

The first presentation I attended was "Why Digital Skills Matter in the Future of Work", which focuses on the fast pace of digitalization and the demand for workers who possess strong digital literacy and technical skills. Kusuma thoughts on this was that digital skills are no longer optional and that they are foundational to participating in the modern workforce. HE goes on and talks about emerging technologies continuously reshaping job roles, requiring individuals to update their skills to remain competitive. Kasuma also talks about how digital literacy empowers people to navigate information-rich environments, collaborate effectively, and contribute to innovation. This directly ties into the core principles of Information Science, which focuses on how people access, use, and manage information in digital contexts. Since I am pursuing a career in web development, listening to this talk really helped me realize the importance of staying up to date with evolving tools/technology, programming languages, and design standards to remain relevant and important in this constantly changing career field.

The next presentation o attended was, With AI, Anyone Can Be a Coder Now, by GitHub CEO Thomas Dohmke, this talk is all about how AI-powered tools are transforming software development. I actually really loved this presentation because my first time experiencing coding with AI was with GitHub. Dohmke demonstrates how AI assistants can generate code from us talking naturally in our prompts, dramatically lowering the barrier to entry level programming. He makes it well known that he believes AI will not replace developers but will instead augment their capabilities, enabling them to focus on higher-level problem-solving and creative tasks. This perspective was particularly important to me with my concentration being in Web Development Technologies. As AI becomes more integrated into development workflows, the role of the developer shifts from writing every line of code manually to orchestrating systems, validating outputs, and designing user-centered solutions. This talk was very important to me and how I shouldn't view AI as a threat to my career but as a tool that can help me with my productivity and open a whole new world of opportunities for innovation. It also highlights the importance of understanding both the technical and ethical implications of AI in software development.

The third and final presentation I attended was, The Future of Skills in the Age of AI, which focuses mostly on the human skills that will forever be essential as automation becomes more widespread. Timis argues that while technical skills are important, unique human abilities; like communication, creativity, empathy, and critical thinking, will always be valuable. He talks a lot about how AI excels at pattern recognition and data processing, but humans are still needed to interpret context, make ethical decisions, and collaborate effectively. This talk reminded me about the interdisciplinary nature of Information Science which blends technology with human focused perspectives. Timis's message really helped reinforce the importance of developing soft skills alongside all the technical skills I pick up and learn. This is going to be key in my development as time goes on. As a future web developer, I will need to communicate with clients, understand user needs, and design accessible, intuitive digital experiences; tasks that only a human's insight and emotional intelligence can do, so I need to stay sharp and prepare to work alongside AI, cause I'm here to stay.

These three presentations provided me with a great perspective into how AI and technological advancements are reshaping the future of my career and all technological careers in general. They all had similar focuses around success in the technology fields requires a balance of technical proficiency, adaptability, and human-centered skills. These events provided me so much information and clarity of mind when it comes to the importance of continuous learning, knowing that AI won't necessarily replace me but help and guide me, and reinforced my commitment to developing both my coding abilities and my softer skills too. More importantly this allowed me to have a better understanding of the direction of the tech industry and the opportunities available within it. As I approach graduating with a degree in Information Science and pursue a career in web development, I can now use this information to help guide me through my professional growth and continuous learning.

References

Dohmke, T. (2023). *With AI, anyone can be a coder now* [Video]. TED.

<https://youtu.be/nv9WwHpOKEg>

Kusuma, I. (2022). *Why digital skills matter in the future of work* [Video]. TEDxYouth@SWA.

https://youtu.be/_XwOzo4uXV4

Timis, D. (2018). *The future of skills in the age of AI* [Video]. TEDxLuxembourgCity.

<https://youtu.be/fBDIAA0GEes>